

the moment – is it stopping you from being able to appreciate what you actually have? Is it holding you back from taking steps towards a similar goal of your own? Is it making you spend more than you can afford, because you think that you deserve those things too?

With feelings that are as uncomfortable and stigmatized as envy, you might have to tease them out bit by bit. This exercise requires fairly radical honesty with yourself, and that's not always the most pleasant experience, but it will really help you to understand some of the ways in which you might be acting as a barrier to your own sense of wellbeing.

Exercise: Understanding your financial envy

For this exercise, I'd like you to try to put aside any judgement of yourself or of others. First, I'd like you to make a list of all of the things that make you envious with regards to money. They could be close to home, such as a friend managing to buy a house ahead of you, or as far-flung as the houses you've seen on *Selling Sunset*. Next, really interrogate where that envy comes from. Why do you want those things – is it really the money or material wealth that you're envious of, or is it the luxury of time, or the peace of mind that can come with having more disposable cash? Then, if you like, you can start to think about ways that you can foster those feelings in your own life – but often just looking at our envy directly rather than